Conversation track 15, 17, 18

Cora rushes over to Conor's desk with some office gossip.

Cora: Have you heard? Apparently we're being bought out!

Conor: I've heard the rumors. The buyer **is thought to be** our biggest rival.

Cora: Them? The ones who keep poaching our clients?

Conor: Allegedly. And the deal **is expected to be** announced next month.

Cora: Great. So should I start updating my CV?

Conor: Not yet. Their CEO **is said to have** kept everyone on last time.

Cora: Last time? So they've done this before?

Conor: Twice. They're **supposed to be** pretty decent employers, actually.

Cora: Well, that's a relief. How do you know all this?

Conor: Let's just say the walls in this building are very thin.

Speak Like a Native track 16

1. The buyer is thought to be our biggest rival.

weak: "is", "to be"
linking: "thought_to"
strong: "buyer", "biggest rival"

"thought to" chỉ đọc một âm t: "thót-tơ". Cụm "is thought to be" đọc lướt; nhấn vào tin chính: "biggest rival".

2. So should I start updating my CV?

linking: "should_I"
change: "updating" (t → d nhẹ)
strong: "CV"

"should I" nối thành "shu-đai". Giọng Úc cũng hay đọc t giữa hai nguyên âm thành d nhẹ: "ấp-đây-đing". Từ viết tắt nhấn chữ cái cuối: C-V.

3. Let's just say the walls in this building are very thin.

change: "just say" (mất âm t)
strong: "walls", "very thin"

Câu úp mở (ý là mình nghe lỏm được): "just say" mất t, đọc "jơs-sây". Nhấn "very thin", giọng tinh nghịch.

• Cụm bị động tường thuật (is said to, is thought to) đọc lướt, nhẹ; dồn trọng âm vào thông tin mới.
• "to have" sau động từ tường thuật đọc rất nhẹ: said to have → "set-tơ-hơv".
• Từ viết tắt nhấn vào chữ cái cuối: C-E-O, C-V.
• Giọng Úc (Cora) thường không đọc r cuối từ, nhưng hay đọc t giữa hai nguyên âm thành d nhẹ như giọng Mỹ.

Role Play track 20

A: Have you heard? Apparently we're being bought out!

B: I've heard the rumors. The buyer is thought to be _____.

A: Them? The ones who keep poaching our clients?

B: Allegedly. And the deal is expected to be announced _____.

A: Great. So should I start updating my CV?

B: Not yet. Their CEO is said to have _____ last time.

A: Last time? So they've done this before?

B: Twice. They're supposed to be pretty decent employers, actually.

A: Well, that's a relief. How do you know all this?

B: Let's just say the walls in this building are very thin.

Study Notes

Allegedly.
Nghe đồn là vậy (chưa ai xác nhận).
Từ hay gặp trong tin tức. Đáp một từ này (thường nửa đùa) để tỏ ý mình chỉ nhắc lại lời đồn, không dám chắc.
Cách nói tương đương: So they say.

The ones who keep poaching our clients?
Cái bên chuyên giành khách của mình ấy hả?
"poach" khách hàng, nhân viên là lôi kéo, "câu" họ từ công ty khác về.
Cách nói tương đương: The ones who keep stealing our clients?

Grammar Focus

It is said / thought / believed that + mệnh đề

Bị động tường thuật: đưa tin mà không nêu nguồn, để giữ khoảng cách (chưa chắc là thật). Hay gặp trong tin tức, cuộc họp.

It's said that the new boss is very strict.
It's believed that the fire started in the kitchen.
It's expected that prices will rise again.

Chủ ngữ + is said / thought / expected + to V / to have V3

Đưa người hoặc vật lên làm chủ ngữ: to V cho hiện tại, tương lai; to have V3 cho việc đã xảy ra. Văn nói thân mật dùng be supposed to.

The singer **is thought to be** recovering at home.
The thief **is believed to have left** the country.
This café **is supposed to be** amazing.

Substitution Drill track 21

1. The buyer is thought to be **our biggest rival**.
   a. a tech company
   b. an overseas bank
   c. a private investor

2. And the deal is expected to be announced **next month**.
   a. any day now
   b. before Christmas
   c. by the end of the year

3. Their CEO is said to have **kept everyone on** last time.
   a. cut half the staff
   b. doubled everyone's pay
   c. closed the old office